

Regulatory & Statutory Reporting (Basel, FATCA, RBI/SEBI)

Hands-On Complete-Knowledge Deep-Dive (India, 2026)

Do-the-task drills: worked examples, entries, interview drills & free practice

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The Regulatory Reporting Landscape

What you'll be able to do

After this chapter you can walk into a reg-reporting interview and correctly answer "who regulates whom, and what do they want filed?" You will be able to draw the four-layer reporting stack (prudential, statistical, transaction, tax), name the actual return/filing that lives in each layer for an Indian bank or NBFC, map the same layer to its global equivalent (US, UK, EU), and explain in one clean sentence why a bank spends crores on this function instead of treating it as a back-office afterthought. You will also know where the jobs are, what they pay in India in 2026, and the certifications that move your CV to the top of the pile.

The essentials

Regulatory reporting is the machinery by which a regulated financial firm proves — on a fixed calendar, in a fixed format — that it is solvent, liquid, honest about its transactions, and compliant with tax-information rules. It is not accounting. Accounting answers "what did we earn?"; reg reporting answers "are you safe, and are you telling the state everything it is entitled to know?"

Who regulates whom in India (2026):

Regulator	Regulates	Core reporting concern
RBI (Reserve Bank of India)	Banks, NBFCs, payment banks, ARCs, AD dealers	Capital, liquidity, asset quality, statistical returns
SEBI	Stock exchanges, brokers, MFs, AIFs, PMS, RIAs, merchant bankers	Investor protection, conduct, systemic risk
IRDAI	Life/general/health insurers, reinsurers, brokers	Solvency margin, policyholder protection
PFRDA	NPS, pension funds, points of presence	Pension corpus safety, subscriber reporting
IFSCA	All financial activity inside GIFT City IFSC	Unified regulator for the IFSC zone

RBI, SEBI, IRDAI, PFRDA and IFSCA sit under a coordinating body, the FSDC (Financial Stability and Development Council), chaired by the Finance Minister. FIU-IND (under the Finance Ministry) is the anti-money-laundering reporting hub — CTRs, STRs, CCRs under the PMLA.

Global counterparts (you'll meet these in any GCC/global bank in India):

Region	Prudential	Markets/conduct	Central bank / statistical
US	Fed (FR Y-9C, FFIEC 031/041 Call Report), OCC	SEC, FINRA, CFTC	Federal Reserve
UK	PRA (COREP/FINREP under UK rules)	FCA	Bank of England
EU	ECB / EBA (COREP, FINREP)	ESMA	ECB, national central banks

The four-layer reporting stack — memorise this; it is the spine of the whole domain:

1. **Prudential** — capital adequacy and liquidity. "Are you strong enough to absorb losses?" Basel III/IV: CAR, CET1, LCR, NSFR, leverage ratio. Filed to RBI (in India), reported via COREP in Europe.
2. **Statistical / supervisory** — granular data the central bank uses to run monetary policy and supervise. RBI's DSB returns, ADF (Automated Data Flow), sectoral credit, BSR (Basic Statistical Returns), CRR/SLR maintenance.
3. **Transaction reporting** — trade-by-trade or account-by-account feeds. Securities transactions (MiFID II / EMIR in EU, CReMS/trade repositories in India), CRILC for large credit exposures, FIU CTR/STR.
4. **Tax information reporting** — FATCA (US), CRS (OECD), TDS/TCS statements, GST returns, SFT (Statement of Financial Transactions, Form 61A).

A single instrument touches several layers at once. A ₹50 crore term loan to a corporate hits prudential (RWA/capital), statistical (sectoral credit return), transaction (CRILC if aggregate exposure $\geq$ ₹5 crore), and tax (interest TDS). That overlap is precisely why the function is hard and well-paid.

Hands-on — step by step

Let's build the mental model with a worked mini-example: a small commercial bank, "Meridian Bank," with a ₹1,000 crore balance sheet. Trace one week's reporting obligations.

1. **Identify the regulator.** Meridian is a scheduled commercial bank → RBI is primary. Its treasury also deals in G-secs and forex → SEBI/FEMA touchpoints and RBI's FED.
2. **Map each layer to a concrete deliverable.** - Prudential: quarterly CAR/RWA return (RBS/Tranche II data), monthly LCR (Form on liquidity), NSFR quarterly. - Statistical: fortnightly Form A (CRR/SLR — Section 42), monthly sectoral deployment of credit, quarterly BSR. - Transaction: CRILC (large exposures $\geq$ ₹5 cr, reported quarterly + weekly for SMA-2/default), FIU CTR by 15th of next month. - Tax: quarterly TDS return (26Q), annual SFT (Form 61A) by 31 May, FATCA/CRS by 31 May.
3. **Attach an owner and a deadline to each.** In a real bank this is a "reporting calendar" — a spreadsheet with 200-plus line items, each with regulation reference, frequency, cut-off, maker, checker, and submission portal (RBI's e-Kuber / XBRL / CIMS; SEBI's SI Portal; income-tax reporting portal).
4. **Trace data lineage for one number.** Take LCR's "cash outflows." It pulls retail deposits from the core banking system (CBS), applies run-off factors, and sums. You must be able to say which source table each figure came from — regulators audit lineage.
5. **Reconcile to the GL.** Every prudential number must tie back to the audited general ledger. If RWA-bearing assets in the capital return don't reconcile to loans-and-advances in the balance sheet, the return is wrong.

The output

A regulator does not want prose; it wants a structured file. The finished artefact of this chapter is a **reporting inventory** — the one document every analyst is handed on day one:

MERIDIAN BANK – REGULATORY REPORTING INVENTORY (extract)

Layer	Return	Regulator	Freq	Deadline	Portal
Prudential	Capital Adequacy	RBI	Quarterly	21 days from qtr	CIMS/XBRL
Prudential	LCR	RBI	Monthly	15th next month	CIMS
Prudential	NSFR	RBI	Quarterly	21 days	CIMS
Statistical	Form A (CRR/SLR)	RBI	Fortnightly	7 days	e-Kuber
Statistical	Sectoral credit	RBI	Monthly	10th next month	CIMS
Transaction	CRILC	RBI	Qtrly+event	21 days / weekly	CRILC portal
Tax	FATCA/CRS	CBDT/IT	Annual	31 May	Reporting Portal
Tax	SFT (61A)	CBDT/IT	Annual	31 May	Reporting Portal
AML	CTR	FIU-IND	Monthly	15th next month	FINGATE

That inventory, kept current against circulars, is the job's foundation.

Checks, gotchas & red flags

- **The GL is the source of truth.** Every prudential figure must reconcile to audited financials. A return that doesn't tie to the balance sheet is a finding.
- **Deadlines are statutory, not aspirational.** RBI penalises late/incorrect returns; SEBI issues administrative warnings and fines. "T+21 days" means 21 calendar days, not working days, unless the circular says otherwise — check.
- **One transaction, many returns.** The classic error is treating layers as independent. A loan restructuring changes RWA (prudential), asset classification (CRILC/DSB), and provisioning — update all, not one.
- **Circulars change the rules mid-year.** RBI Master Directions are living documents. The red flag is running last quarter's template without checking for an amending circular.
- **"Nil" is still a return.** Many returns require a nil filing when there's nothing to report; silence is a default.

Interview drill

Q: A retail deposit and a wholesale deposit of the same size — do they hit regulatory reports differently?

A: Yes, materially. For LCR, retail/small-business deposits get a low run-off factor (5–10%) because they're "sticky," while unsecured wholesale funding from a financial counterparty gets up to 100% run-off. So the wholesale deposit consumes far more HQLA in the liquidity calculation. For capital they may be identical (deposits aren't risk-weighted assets), but for NSFR the retail deposit gets higher Available Stable Funding weighting. Same rupee value, very different regulatory footprint.

Q: Why do banks spend so heavily on reg reporting instead of automating it once and forgetting it?

A: Three reasons. First, the rules change constantly — Basel endgame, RBI Master Direction updates, new FATCA/CRS schemas — so it's a maintenance problem, not a build-once problem. Second, penalties and reputational cost of a wrong return dwarf the cost of doing it well. Third, data lineage: the same number must reconcile across prudential, statistical and tax layers pulled from different systems, and keeping those tied requires ongoing controls, reconciliation, and skilled people.

Learn/practise (free)

- **RBI website** → **Notifications** → **Master Directions** (free): read the Master Direction on Financial Statements and the Basel III capital circular. This is the primary source; everything else is commentary.
- **RBI DBIE / CIMS public data portal** (free): browse the actual statistical returns banks file — you'll see the real formats.
- **BIS.org** (free): the Basel Framework consolidated text, searchable, no paywall.
- **SEBI Intermediaries Portal circulars** and **Income-tax Reporting Portal FATCA/CRS guidance notes** (free PDFs).
- Rehearse by building your own reporting inventory (as above) for a fictional bank in Excel, one row per return, sourced from real RBI circulars. This single artefact demonstrates domain fluency better than any certificate.

Career/pay angle (India, 2026): Reg-reporting analysts sit in bank finance, GCC captive centres (JPMorgan, Deutsche, Nomura, UBS in Bengaluru/Mumbai/Pune), and Big-4 risk advisory. Entry analyst: ₹6–11 lakh; 3–5 yr with COREP/Basel exposure: ₹14–24 lakh; AVP/manager: ₹25–45 lakh. The differentiators that raise pay: hands-on COREP/FINREP or RBI ADF experience, Axiom/Vermeg/OneSumX tooling, and the ability to reason about a number's lineage. FRM and the RBI/IIBF certifications help; SQL + a prudential mind help more.

Basel III/IV: Capital & Liquidity (RWA, CAR, CET1, LCR, NSFR)

What you'll be able to do

You will be able to take a simple bank balance sheet and compute, by hand, the four ratios every prudential regulator cares about: the Capital Adequacy Ratio (CAR), the Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio, the Liquidity Coverage Ratio (LCR), and the Net Stable Funding Ratio (NSFR). You'll know what goes in each capital tier, how risk-weighted assets (RWA) are built, which run-off and haircut factors to apply, and — crucially — what the analyst actually hands over: a capital return and a liquidity return that reconcile to the GL and clear the regulatory minimums.

The essentials

Basel III/IV is the global bank-capital rulebook from the Basel Committee (BIS). India implements it through RBI's Master Circular on Basel III Capital Regulations. "Basel IV" (the 2017 finalisation — output floor, revised standardised approaches for credit/operational risk) is phasing in globally through 2025–2028; RBI is adopting elements progressively.

Capital tiers — capital is ranked by loss-absorbing quality:

Tier	What it is	Loss absorption
CET1 (Common Equity Tier 1)	Paid-up equity + retained earnings + disclosed reserves – regulatory deductions (goodwill, DTA, intangibles)	Highest — first to absorb losses, going concern
AT1 (Additional Tier 1)	Perpetual non-cumulative instruments (e.g. AT1 bonds) with loss-absorption triggers	Going concern
Tier 2	Subordinated debt (min 5-yr), general provisions (capped)	Gone concern — absorbs on liquidation

Total Capital = CET1 + AT1 + Tier 2.

The regulatory minimums (RBI, 2026):

Ratio	Basel min	RBI min (incl. CCB)
CET1	4.5%	5.5% + 2.5% CCB = 8.0%
Tier 1	6.0%	7.0%
Total CAR	8.0%	9.0% + 2.5% CCB = 11.5%
Leverage ratio	3.0%	3.5% (4% for D-SIBs)
LCR	100%	100%
NSFR	100%	100%

CCB = Capital Conservation Buffer. D-SIBs (SBI, HDFC Bank, ICICI) carry an additional surcharge.

RWA — assets weighted by riskiness. Cash and sovereign (G-sec) = 0%; home loans ~35–50%; corporate loans 20–150% by rating; unrated corporate 100%. $RWA = \sum(\text{exposure} \times \text{risk weight})$. Total RWA = credit RWA + market RWA + operational RWA.

CAR = Total Capital / Total RWA. CET1 ratio = CET1 / Total RWA.

LCR = Stock of HQLA / Total net cash outflows over 30 days $\geq 100\%$. HQLA: Level 1 (cash, G-secs, at 100% value) and Level 2 (high-grade corporate/covered bonds, haircut, capped). Net outflows = stressed outflows – min(inflows, 75% of outflows).

NSFR = Available Stable Funding / Required Stable Funding $\geq 100\%$. ASF weights funding by stability (capital 100%, stable retail deposits 95%, wholesale <1yr lower). RSF weights assets by how much stable funding they need to hold (cash 0%, loans >1yr 85–100%).

Hands-on — step by step

Take **Meridian Bank**. Simplified balance sheet (₹ crore):

Assets: Cash 50 · G-secs 200 · Home loans 300 · Corporate loans (unrated) 400 · Fixed assets 50 = **1,000**.

Liabilities: Equity (paid-up + reserves) 80 · AT1 bonds 10 · Tier-2 sub-debt 20 · Retail deposits 700 · Wholesale deposits (financial cpty) 190 = **1,000**.

Step 1 — Capital. CET1 = 80 (assume no deductions). AT1 = 10 → Tier 1 = 90. Tier 2 = 20. Total Capital = 110.

Step 2 — Credit RWA. - Cash: $50 \times 0\% = 0$ - G-secs: $200 \times 0\% = 0$ - Home loans: $300 \times 35\% = 105$ - Corporate (unrated): $400 \times 100\% = 400$ - Fixed assets: $50 \times 100\% = 50$ - Credit RWA = **555**. Add market + operational RWA, say 45 → **Total RWA = 600**.

Step 3 — Ratios. - CAR = $110 / 600 = 18.33\%$ ($\geq 11.5\%$ ✓) - CET1 ratio = $80 / 600 = 13.33\%$ ($\geq 8.0\%$ ✓) - Tier 1 = $90 / 600 = 15.0\%$ (✓)

Step 4 — LCR. HQLA = Cash 50 (L1, 100%) + G-secs 200 (L1, 100%) = **250**. Outflows (30-day stress): Retail deposits $700 \times 5\% = 35$; Wholesale $190 \times 100\% = 190$. Total outflows = **225**. Inflows: assume contractual inflows of 40; capped at 75% of outflows = 168, so use 40. Net outflows = $225 - 40 = 185$. LCR = $250 / 185 = 135.1\%$ ($\geq 100\%$ ✓).

Step 5 — NSFR. ASF: Equity+AT1+T2 = $110 \times 100\% = 110$; Retail deposits $700 \times 95\% = 665$; Wholesale <1yr $190 \times 0\%$ (or low) = 0. ASF = **775**. RSF: Cash $50 \times 0\% = 0$; G-secs $200 \times 5\% = 10$; Home loans $300 \times 65\% = 195$; Corporate loans $400 \times 85\% = 340$; Fixed assets $50 \times 100\% = 50$. RSF = **595**. NSFR = $775 / 595 = 130.3\%$ ($\geq 100\%$ ✓).

The output

The analyst produces a **capital-and-liquidity dashboard** that goes to the CFO and into the RBI return:

MERIDIAN BANK – PRUDENTIAL DASHBOARD (₹ cr) Q1 FY27

CAPITAL

CET1	80	CET1 ratio	13.33%	(min 8.00%)	✓
Tier 1	90	Tier 1 ratio	15.00%	(min 7.00%)	✓
Total capital	110	Total CAR	18.33%	(min 11.50%)	✓
Total RWA	600				
of which credit RWA	555				

LIQUIDITY

HQLA	250	LCR	135.1%	(min 100%)	✓
Net 30-day outflows	185				
ASF	775	NSFR	130.3%	(min 100%)	✓
RSF	595				

Leverage: Tier1 90 / exposure 1000 = 9.0% (min 3.5%) ✓

Checks, gotchas & red flags

- **CET1 deductions are where errors hide.** Goodwill, intangibles, deferred tax assets that rely on future profitability, and investments in own shares must be deducted from CET1. Forgetting them overstates capital — a serious finding.
- **RWA must reconcile to the balance sheet.** Total exposures feeding credit RWA should tie to gross advances + investments. If they don't, the risk weights are being applied to the wrong base.
- **LCR is a 30-day stress, not a snapshot of today's cash.** Apply run-off factors; don't just count deposits. And remember the inflow cap: inflows can offset at most 75% of outflows, so you always hold some HQLA.
- **HQLA Level 2 caps.** Level 2 assets can't exceed 40% of total HQLA (Level 2B capped at 15%), and carry haircuts (15% for 2A). Loading up on corporate bonds doesn't rescue a weak LCR.
- **NSFR and LCR pull in opposite directions on tenor.** Short wholesale funding is cheap but hurts both ratios. Analysts flag maturity mismatches, not just point ratios.
- **Undrawn commitments create outflows.** Committed credit/liquidity lines generate LCR outflows even though nothing has been drawn — easy to miss.

Interview drill

Q: A bank swaps ₹100 cr of unrated corporate loans for ₹100 cr of G-secs. What happens to CAR and LCR? A: CAR improves: G-secs carry 0% risk weight vs 100% for unrated corporates, so RWA falls by ₹100 cr, raising the ratio (same capital / smaller denominator). LCR also improves: G-secs are Level 1 HQLA at 100% value, so HQLA rises by ₹100 cr while corporate loans weren't HQLA at all. It's a classic "de-risking" trade — but NII (interest income) drops because G-secs yield less than corporate loans. Capital and liquidity strength bought at the cost of profitability.

Q: Why is CET1 more important than Total CAR to a regulator? A: Because CET1 is going-concern, permanent, fully loss-absorbing equity — it protects the bank while it's still operating. Tier 2 only absorbs losses in liquidation (gone-concern), by which point depositors may already be hurt. A bank can have a healthy Total CAR propped up by sub-debt yet a thin CET1, which is fragile. That's why post-2008 Basel III raised the CET1 minimum specifically and made it the binding constraint.

Learn/practise (free)

- **BIS Basel Framework** (bis.org, free): the CAP, LCR (LCR30) and NSFR (NSF) chapters give exact factors — the authoritative source.
- **RBI Master Circular — Basel III Capital Regulations** and the LCR/NSFR Master Directions (free PDFs) for the India-specific weights.
- Build the Meridian model in Excel: one tab for RWA (exposure $\times$ risk weight), one for LCR (outflow factors), one for NSFR (ASF/RSF weights). Stress-test it — halve retail deposits, watch LCR break. This is exactly what an analyst does.
- Any listed Indian bank's **Basel III Pillar 3 disclosure** (on its investor-relations page, free) shows a real capital and RWA table — reverse-engineer it against your model.

FATCA, CRS & Cross-Border Reporting

What you'll be able to do

You will be able to take a real customer onboarding pack, classify the account holder and the entity, decide whether the account is "reportable," identify the reportable jurisdiction(s), run the due-diligence tests, and assemble the fields that go into the annual reporting file. You'll know the difference between FATCA and CRS, when US withholding bites, and how the Indian rules (Income-tax Rules 114F, 114G, 114H) map onto the global framework. You'll finish with a worked classification of a genuinely tricky entity account.

The essentials

FATCA (Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act, US, 2010) forces non-US financial institutions to identify accounts held by **US persons** and report them — via their local tax authority under an Inter-Governmental Agreement (IGA) — to the IRS. India signed a Model 1 IGA: Indian FIs report to the CBDT, which passes data to the IRS. Non-compliance risks 30% US withholding on US-source income.

CRS (Common Reporting Standard, OECD, 2014) is the multilateral cousin — over 100 jurisdictions automatically exchange financial-account information about each other's tax residents. There is no single "CRS country"; you report an account to *every* jurisdiction where the holder is tax-resident (other than India). No withholding mechanism — it's pure information exchange.

Feature	FATCA	CRS
Origin	US law	OECD multilateral
Who's reported	US persons	Tax residents of any partner jurisdiction
Threshold	Pre-existing individual accounts < US\$50,000 may be exempt	No de-minimis for new accounts; limited for pre-existing
Enforcement	30% withholding	Peer pressure / local penalties
India rule	Rule 114F–H	Rule 114F–H (same machinery)

India's legal hook: Income-tax Rules **114F** (definitions — Financial Institution, Financial Account, Reportable Account), **114G** (information to be maintained and reported — Form 61B), **114H** (due-diligence procedures). Reporting Financial Institutions file **Form 61B** annually by **31 May** on the income-tax Reporting Portal.

Entity classification is the hard part. Every account holder is either an **individual** or an **entity**. Entities split into: - **Financial Institutions (FIs)**: depository, custodial, investment entity, or specified insurance company. Generally not reportable themselves (they report their own accounts). - **Non-Financial Entities (NFEs)**: - **Active NFE** — mostly operating business (<50% passive income and <50% passive assets), or listed/govt/etc. Only the entity's own residence matters. - **Passive NFE** — everything else (holding companies, family investment vehicles). Here you must **look through** to the **controlling persons** (typically ≥25% beneficial owners) and test *their* residence.

Due diligence differs by account: - **New accounts**: collect a **self-certification** at onboarding (residence, TIN). Must be reasonable vs other KYC. - **Pre-existing accounts**: apply **indicia** searches — for individuals,

look for US/foreign place of birth, address, phone, standing instructions, power of attorney, "hold mail" address. High-value pre-existing accounts get an enhanced relationship-manager enquiry.

Hands-on — step by step

Scenario: "Sunrise Holdings Pvt Ltd" opens a demat + custody account with an Indian broker (a Reporting FI). Onboarding facts: - Sunrise is India-incorporated, unlisted. - 90% of its income last year was dividends and capital gains (it's an investment holding company). - Shareholders: Mr A (India-resident, 40%), Ms B (US citizen resident in Dubai, 35%), a trust (25%) whose settlor is UK-resident.

Step 1 — Is the holder an entity? Yes, Sunrise is an entity, not an individual.

Step 2 — FI or NFE? Sunrise doesn't accept deposits, hold assets for others, or act as an investment manager for clients — it invests its own money. It's an **NFE**, not an FI. (If it were professionally managed by another FI, it could be an "investment entity"; here assume self-managed by directors → NFE.)

Step 3 — Active or Passive NFE? >50% of income is passive (dividends, gains) → **Passive NFE**. This is the trigger to look through.

Step 4 — Identify controlling persons (≥25% or control). - Mr A, 40% — India-resident → not reportable. - Ms B, 35% — US citizen (FATCA person) and Dubai (UAE) tax-resident (CRS) → reportable under **both** FATCA (US) and CRS (UAE). - Trust, 25% — look through to controlling persons of the trust: settlor is UK-resident → **UK is a reportable jurisdiction** under CRS.

Step 5 — Collect self-certifications and TINs. Ms B's US TIN (SSN/ITIN) for FATCA, UAE TIN for CRS; UK settlor's UK UTR. Validate reasonableness against passports/KYC.

Step 6 — Determine account balance / values. Report year-end account balance or value; for custody accounts also gross proceeds and income paid/credited during the year.

Step 7 — Assemble the report. Sunrise's account becomes a reportable account with **three** controlling-person reports: Ms B to the US (FATCA) and to the UAE (CRS), and the UK settlor to the UK (CRS). Mr A generates no report.

The output

The finished artefact is the **Form 61B / CRS-FATCA XML record** (shown here in readable form; the portal ingests schema-validated XML):

REPORTING FI: Sunrise's Broker (GIIN: XXXXXX.99999.SL.356) Period: CY2025
ACCOUNT: Custody A/C 356-Sunrise Holdings Pvt Ltd
Account Holder: Sunrise Holdings Pvt Ltd – Passive NFE
Year-end balance: INR 4,20,00,000
Controlling Person 1: Ms B
Residence: US (FATCA) + AE/UAE (CRS)
US TIN: 123-45-6789 | UAE TIN: 784-xxxx
Reportable to: IRS (via CBDT), UAE tax authority
Controlling Person 2: Trust – look-through settlor
Residence: GB (UK) | UK TIN (UTR): 1234567890
Reportable to: HMRC (via CBDT)
Controlling Person 3: Mr A – IN resident – NOT reported
Payments during year: Dividends INR 22,00,000; Gross proceeds INR 1,10,00,000

The broker submits Form 61B by 31 May; CBDT routes each controlling-person record to the correct foreign authority.

Checks, gotchas & red flags

- **US citizenship = US person regardless of where they live.** Ms B lives in Dubai but her US citizenship makes her FATCA-reportable. This is the single most-missed rule.
- **Passive NFE ⇒ look through.** The commonest error is reporting only the entity's residence (India) and stopping. If it's a passive NFE, you must test the controlling persons — that's the whole point.
- **A person can be reportable to multiple jurisdictions.** Dual residence/citizenship means multiple records for the same person. Don't deduplicate away a valid second jurisdiction.
- **Self-certification must be reasonable.** If KYC shows a US birthplace but the self-cert says "no US person," you have an unresolved indicium — you cannot just accept the form.
- **Nil reporting is required.** If you have no reportable accounts, you still file a nil statement in India.
- **TIN missing ≠ skip.** Report with a documented reason; don't silently drop the record.
- **Investment entity vs passive NFE.** A professionally-managed investment vehicle in a non-participating jurisdiction can flip classification — check who manages the entity.

Interview drill

Q: An Indian resident holding a US green card opens an account. Reportable? Under what? A: Yes, under FATCA. A green-card holder is a US person for US tax purposes regardless of Indian residence, so the account is FATCA-reportable to the IRS via CBDT. It's generally not CRS-reportable to the US (the US isn't a CRS participant), and not reportable to any other jurisdiction unless she's also tax-resident elsewhere. So this is a FATCA-only case — a good test of whether you know the US sits outside CRS.

Q: What's the practical difference between an Active and a Passive NFE for reporting? A: For an Active NFE you only care about the entity's own tax residence — if it's India-resident and not otherwise reportable, you're done, no look-through. For a Passive NFE you must identify the controlling persons (typically ≥25% beneficial owners) and test each one's residence/citizenship, then report the account against every

reportable controlling person. Misclassifying a passive holding company as active is the way real reporting failures happen, because it suppresses the look-through entirely.

Learn/practise (free)

- **OECD Automatic Exchange Portal** (oecd.org, free): the CRS Standard, the CRS-by-jurisdiction status table, and the official commentary with worked entity-classification examples.
- **IRS FATCA pages** (irs.gov, free): the IGA list, entity classification flowcharts, and the W-8BEN-E / W-9 forms you'll actually collect.
- **Income-tax India Reporting Portal → Resources** (free): the Form 61B schema, the Guidance Note on FATCA and CRS (a genuinely excellent 100-page free PDF with Indian examples), and Rules 114F–H.
- Rehearse by taking five fictional entities (a listed company, a family trust, a holding co, a fund, an individual with a US birthplace) and classifying each end-to-end. Build the decision tree once and the classifications become mechanical.

RBI & SEBI India Returns (Banks, NBFCs, Market Intermediaries)

What you'll be able to do

You will be able to name the returns an Indian bank, NBFC and SEBI-registered intermediary actually file, describe the RBS/DSB/ADF concept that underpins RBI's data collection, explain what CRILC is and when a weekly filing is triggered, and walk through a reg-reporting analyst's real day — from data extraction to maker-checker to portal submission. You'll produce a filled-in return extract and a reporting calendar so the abstractions become concrete.

The essentials

RBI's supervisory architecture. RBI moved from transaction-by-transaction inspection to **RBS — Risk-Based Supervision**, where the bank's own data feeds drive the supervisor's risk assessment. The data plumbing behind it:

- **DSB returns (Off-site Surveillance)** — the "Domestic Statutory and other returns" set that RBI's off-site monitoring uses. These carry capital adequacy, asset quality, large exposures, profitability. Historically named DSB-I, II, III etc.; now largely subsumed under the **RBS Tranche** data collection.
- **ADF (Automated Data Flow)** — RBI's mandate that returns be generated **straight from source systems** (CBS, treasury, GL) with **no manual intervention**, to guarantee data integrity. An ADF-compliant bank pulls the return from a central data repository, not from someone's spreadsheet.
- **CIMS (Centralised Information Management System)** — RBI's current data-receipt platform (successor to XBRL/e-Data), where most returns are now submitted.

Key RBI returns for a bank:

Return	What	Frequency
Form A (Section 42)	CRR/SLR maintenance	Fortnightly
Form VIII	SLR holdings	Monthly
RCA3 / Basel III capital	CAR, RWA, capital tiers	Quarterly
LCR / NSFR / LR	Liquidity & leverage	Monthly/Quarterly
DSB / RBS Tranche	Off-site risk data	Quarterly
CRILC	Large credit exposures	Quarterly + event
SLBC / sectoral credit	Priority-sector, deployment	Monthly/Quarterly
RLC / FTD	Forex, cross-border	Various

CRILC — Central Repository of Information on Large Credits. Banks report every borrower with **aggregate exposure $\geq$ ₹5 crore** quarterly. Critically, when an account becomes **SMA-2** (principal/interest overdue 61–90 days) or defaults, a **weekly** report is triggered, and RBI shares it across lenders — so no bank

can hide a stressed borrower. SMA classification: SMA-0 (1–30 days overdue), SMA-1 (31–60), SMA-2 (61–90); beyond 90 days it's an NPA.

NBFC returns. NBFCs file on RBI's **CIMS/COSMOS** portal depending on layer (RBI's Scale-Based Regulation: Base, Middle, Upper, Top layers). Core returns: **DNBS-01** (financial details, quarterly for deposit-taking/large), **DNBS-02** (prudential norms — CRAR, provisioning), **DNBS-03** (important financial parameters), **DNBS-04A/B** (structural & dynamic liquidity / ALM), **DNBS-10** (statutory auditor certificate, annual), **DNBS-13** (overseas investment). NBFCs also feed CRILC if exposures qualify.

SEBI reporting for market intermediaries:

Entity	Key filings
Stock brokers	Enhanced supervision monthly (client funds/securities), quarterly internal audit, half-yearly net worth
Mutual funds (AMCs)	Monthly portfolio disclosure, half-yearly, risk-o-meter, expense-ratio, scheme reporting to SEBI
AIFs	Quarterly report to SEBI (per category), PPM audit annually, valuation reporting
PMS	Monthly reporting to SEBI, quarterly to clients, APMI reporting
RIAs	Half-yearly reporting, annual compliance audit
Merchant bankers/RTAs	Periodic + event-based (offer documents, complaints — SCORES)

SEBI filings go through the **SEBI Intermediary Portal (SI Portal)**, exchange platforms (NSE/BSE ENIT), and **SCORES** for grievances.

Hands-on — step by step

Task: file a quarter's CRILC for Meridian Bank. Walk the analyst workflow.

1. **Extract.** Pull all borrowers with aggregate fund-based + non-fund-based exposure $\geq$ ₹5 crore from the CBS as at quarter-end. Say 120 borrowers, total exposure ₹3,400 crore.
2. **Enrich.** For each: outstanding, sanctioned limit, asset classification (Standard/SMA-0/1/2/NPA), days-past-due, and any restructuring flag. Join borrower CIN/PAN for unique identification across banks.
3. **Apply SMA logic.** One borrower, "Zenith Auto," has interest overdue 68 days → **SMA-2**. This flags a **weekly** reporting obligation for Zenith until it cures or turns NPA.
4. **Reconcile.** Total CRILC exposure must tie to the advances subledger. If CRILC shows ₹3,400 cr but the GL advances (for $\geq$ ₹5 cr accounts) show ₹3,380 cr, find the ₹20 cr gap *before* filing — usually an unbooked disbursement or an excluded facility type.
5. **Maker-checker.** Maker prepares the return; an independent checker validates classification and totals; both are logged. This is a hard control, not optional.
6. **Submit.** Upload the schema-validated file to the CRILC module on the RBI portal within the deadline (T+21 days for quarterly; the SMA-2 weekly file every Friday).
7. **Archive & audit trail.** Store the submission acknowledgement, the source extract, and the reconciliation. Auditors and RBI inspection will ask for lineage.

A reg-reporting analyst's actual day: morning — run extraction jobs, check overnight data-load failures; mid-morning — reconcile returns to GL, chase breaks with business units; midday — maker-checker sign-offs; afternoon — submit due returns, handle RBI/SEBI queries on prior filings, update the reporting calendar for circular changes; ongoing — improve automation so more returns become ADF-compliant.

The output

The artefact is the **CRILC submission summary + a reporting calendar row**:

MERIDIAN BANK – CRILC QUARTERLY SUBMISSION Q1 FY27

Total borrowers ≥ INR 5 cr: 120

Aggregate exposure: INR 3,400 cr (ties to GL advances ✓)

Standard: INR 3,180 cr

SMA-0/1: INR 150 cr

SMA-2 (weekly trigger): INR 40 cr [Zenith Auto – 68 dpd]

NPA: INR 30 cr

Submission: CIMS/CRILC module | Ack: CRILC-2027-Q1-004821 | Filed: T+18 days ✓

REPORTING CALENDAR (extract)

Return	Freq	Cut-off	Deadline	Maker	Checker	Portal
CRILC	Qtrly	Qtr-end	T+21 days	R.Nair	S.Iyer	CIMS
CRILC-wk	Weekly(SMA2)	Every Friday	Same day	R.Nair	S.Iyer	CIMS
Form A	Fortnightly	Alt Friday	T+7 days	K.Rao	S.Iyer	e-Kuber

Checks, gotchas & red flags

- **CRILC ≥ ₹5 crore is aggregate, not per-facility.** A borrower with three ₹2 cr facilities (₹6 cr total) is in scope. Filtering per-facility understates the return.
- **SMA-2 triggers weekly, not quarterly.** Miss the weekly filing and you've breached a specific RBI requirement designed to catch inter-bank stress early.
- **ADF means no manual touch.** If an analyst edits a return in Excel after extraction, it's no longer ADF-compliant and the integrity claim breaks. Fix the source, not the output.
- **Asset classification must be consistent across returns.** The same account can't be Standard in DSB and SMA-2 in CRILC — RBI cross-checks and inconsistency is a red flag.
- **SEBI net-worth/segregation breaches are event-based.** A broker's client-funds shortfall isn't a "wait for month-end" item; enhanced supervision expects prompt reporting.
- **Nil and event returns still count.** Many SEBI/RBI returns require a nil filing; absence is treated as non-filing.
- **Deadlines are calendar days.** "T+21" almost always means calendar, and a portal outage on the last day is your problem, not the regulator's — file early.

Interview drill

Q: What exactly is the ADF mandate and why does RBI insist on it? A: Automated Data Flow requires banks to generate regulatory returns directly from source systems — core banking, treasury, GL — into a

central repository and out to RBI, with zero manual intervention. RBI insists because manual, spreadsheet-built returns are error-prone and manipulable; if the number is pulled straight from the transaction system, RBI can trust its integrity and rely on it for risk-based supervision. Practically it means the reg-reporting team's job shifts from "keying numbers" to "building and controlling data pipelines and reconciliations."

Q: A ₹6 crore borrower goes 65 days overdue. Walk me through the CRILC consequence. A: At $\geq ₹5$ cr aggregate the borrower is already in the quarterly CRILC. At 65 days overdue it's SMA-2 (the 61–90 day bucket). SMA-2 triggers a weekly CRILC report every Friday until the account either cures below SMA-2 or slips past 90 days into NPA. RBI shares that SMA-2 status with every other lender to the same borrower, so all banks see the stress simultaneously — that early-warning, no-hiding function is the whole purpose of CRILC.

Learn/practise (free)

- **RBI website** → **Regulatory Reporting / Master Directions** (free): the CRILC circular, the Scale-Based Regulation framework for NBFCs, and the list of returns with formats.
- **RBI CIMS portal public pages and the "Returns" master list** (free) show the actual return codes (DNBS series, RCA3, Form A).
- **SEBI Intermediaries section + APMI/AMFI circulars** (free) for broker, PMS, AIF and MF reporting formats; the SI Portal user manuals are public.
- Rehearse by downloading a real NBFC's annual report and mapping its disclosures to the DNBS returns that would have produced them; and by building the CRILC extract-reconcile-submit workflow in Excel with dummy data, including the SMA ageing logic (a simple days-past-due formula bucketing into SMA-0/1/2/NPA). That single spreadsheet demonstrates you understand both the rule and the data mechanics.

Reg-Reporting Platforms & Workflow: AxiomSL, OneSumX, Regnology

What you'll be able to do

By the end of this chapter you will be able to walk into an interview for a regulatory-reporting analyst role — the Luxoft / DXC / GCC "Reg Reporting COE" type of job — and talk credibly about **how the reporting platforms actually work end-to-end**: how source data is ingested, mapped to a return template, run through validation rules, reconciled to the general ledger (GL), signed off, and submitted to the regulator (RBI, PRA, EBA, MAS, HKMA, Fed). You'll know the names of the three market-leading engines — **AxiomSL (now part of Adenza / Nasdaq)**, **Wolters Kluwer OneSumW / OneSumX**, and **Regnology (the merged BearingPoint RegTech + Vizor)** — what each does, where they differ, and what an analyst's day on them looks like. You will also understand, honestly, that you **cannot get a personal login** to any of these; they are licensed to banks, so I'll give you the free way to build the exact same muscle.

The essentials

A regulatory reporting platform is essentially a **rules engine sitting on top of a data warehouse**. Its job: take granular bank data, transform it into the line-items a regulator's template demands, prove the numbers are internally consistent, and file them in the required electronic format (XBRL, XML, CSV, or the regulator's proprietary schema).

The three big engines, at a glance:

Platform	Owner (2026)	Strength	Typical filer
AxiomSL ControllerView	Adenza → Nasdaq	Data-integration depth, huge global taxonomy library, transparent lineage	Large global/US banks, foreign-bank branches
OneSumX for Regulatory Reporting	Wolters Kluwer	Regulatory Update Service (WK's own team maintains the rules), Basel/finance integration	European + APAC banks, insurers
Regnology (Rcloud / ABACUS)	Regnology	Strong on EBA/ECB granular reporting, AnaCredit, SaaS/cloud, regulator-side tooling	EU banks, and regulators themselves

Whatever the brand, the pipeline is the **same five stages**:

1. **Ingestion / data sourcing** — pull balances and transactions from the GL, sub-ledgers, risk systems, trade/position stores. Usually a nightly batch of flat files or a data-mart feed loaded to a staging area.
2. **Mapping to templates** — assign each source record to a regulatory line-item using dimensions (product, counterparty type, residual maturity, currency, risk weight, IFRS-9 stage). This is the "classification" step.
3. **Validation rules** — run the regulator's published edit checks (EBA calls them "validation rules", the Fed "edit checks"): intra-form arithmetic, cross-form consistency, sign checks, plausibility ranges.
4. **Reconciliation to GL** — prove the return ties back to audited financials (total assets on the return = balance-sheet total assets).

5. **Sign-off & submission** — four-eyes review, maker-checker, attestation by an accountable person, then filing in the regulator's channel.

The **Regulatory Update Service** concept matters: because rules change every quarter, banks pay the vendor to ship updated taxonomies (e.g. EBA DPM 3.x, RBI's revised ADF/RBS returns) so the analyst maps *once* and the engine applies the new logic.

Hands-on — step by step

Let's carry a small worked example through a OneSumX-style workflow, producing a COREP-style **Own Funds / capital line** and reconciling it. Numbers are ₹ crore for a fictional foreign-bank branch, "Meridian Bank India".

Step 1 — Source the data. The nightly batch lands three staging files: - `GL_BALANCES.csv` — every GL account with a closing balance. - `LOANS.csv` — loan-level: borrower, product, rating, exposure, IFRS-9 stage. - `CAPITAL.csv` — equity, reserves, AT1 instruments.

You load them into the platform's staging schema. In AxiomSL you'd point a "DataSource" object at the file; in OneSumX you use the "Data Integration Layer".

Step 2 — Map to the template. You build (or inherit) a mapping table. Example rows:

Source GL code	Description	Reg line-item	Bucket logic
3001	Paid-up equity	CET1 – Capital instruments	direct
3100	Retained earnings	CET1 – Retained earnings	direct
3400	AT1 perpetual bond	Additional Tier 1	direct
1200-1299	Corporate loans	Credit RWA – Corporates	×100% RW
1300-1399	Retail loans	Credit RWA – Retail	×75% RW

Step 3 — Compute risk-weighted assets and capital. Say the mapped totals are:

- CET1 capital = equity 800 + retained earnings 400 – intangibles 50 = **1,150**
- AT1 = **150** → Tier 1 = 1,300
- Tier 2 (sub-debt + eligible provisions) = **200** → Total capital = **1,500**
- Corporate exposure 6,000 × 100% = 6,000 RWA
- Retail exposure 2,000 × 75% = 1,500 RWA
- Operational + market RWA (given) = 2,500
- **Total RWA = 10,000**

Step 4 — Ratios (the engine fills these cells automatically): - CET1 ratio = 1,150 / 10,000 = **11.50%** - Tier 1 ratio = 1,300 / 10,000 = **13.00%** - Total Capital Ratio (CRAR) = 1,500 / 10,000 = **15.00%**

Step 5 — Run validation rules. The engine fires edit checks such as: - `v0001` : CET1 ≤ Tier 1 ≤ Total capital → 1,150 ≤ 1,300 ≤ 1,500 ✓ - `v0234` : Total RWA = Σ(credit + market + operational) → 6,000+1,500+2,500 = 10,000 ✓ - `v0570` : CRAR ≥ regulatory minimum (RBI 11.5% incl. CCB) → 15.0% ✓

Any failing rule throws a blocking error you must clear before submission.

Step 6 — Reconcile to GL. Pull "total assets" from the return and compare to the trial-balance total assets. Suppose return shows 9,850 but GL shows 9,900 — a **50 crore break**. You drill the lineage: the engine shows the break sits in "other assets", traced to GL account 1950 that was never mapped. You add the mapping row, re-run, break = 0. This drill-down is the platform's killer feature: **data lineage** from the reported cell back to the source transaction.

Step 7 — Sign-off & submit. The preparer (you) marks the return "Ready". A reviewer does four-eyes, checks the variance commentary ("RWA up 300 cr QoQ on new corporate lending"), and approves. The accountable executive attests. The engine generates the **XBRL instance** against the regulator's taxonomy and files it through the channel (for RBI, the CIMS/ADF portal; for EBA, the national competent authority's collection gateway).

The output

The finished artefact is the **validated, reconciled return package**:

MERIDIAN BANK INDIA – CAPITAL ADEQUACY RETURN (as at 30-Jun-2026) ₹ crore

CET1 capital	1,150
Additional Tier 1	150
Tier 1 capital	1,300
Tier 2 capital	200
TOTAL CAPITAL (eligible)	1,500
Credit risk RWA	7,500
Market risk RWA	900
Operational risk RWA	1,600
TOTAL RWA	10,000

CET1 ratio 11.50% Tier 1 13.00% CRAR 15.00%

Validation: 412 rules run, 0 failures. GL recon: NIL break.

Preparer: A.Analyst Reviewer: B.Manager Attested: C.CFO Status: SUBMITTED

Attached: variance commentary, validation log, and GL reconciliation showing return total assets = GL total assets = 9,900.

Checks, gotchas & red flags

- **GL must tie exactly.** A return that doesn't reconcile to audited financials is the fastest way to a regulator query. Zero tolerance on the balance-sheet total; document any timing differences.
- **Unmapped accounts** silently drop numbers. Always run a "completeness" check: $\Sigma(\text{mapped source}) = \Sigma(\text{total GL})$. Any residual = an unmapped bucket.
- **Sign conventions.** Regulators expect provisions/contra-assets in specific signs; a flipped sign passes arithmetic but fails a plausibility rule.
- **Taxonomy version drift.** Filing last quarter's DPM against this quarter's gateway = rejected instance. Confirm the Regulatory Update Service is applied.

- **Manual overrides ("adjustments").** Every top-side journal in the reporting layer needs an audit trail and reviewer sign-off — auditors hunt these.
- **Double counting across returns.** Same exposure feeding CRAR and LCR must be consistent; cross-form validation rules exist precisely to catch this.

Interview drill

Q1. "Walk me through what happens between the GL closing and a return being filed." *Answer:* Nightly the GL and sub-ledgers feed staging; the engine maps each record to reg line-items using product/counterparty/maturity dimensions; it computes the return, runs the regulator's validation rules, and I reconcile the return back to the trial balance. Breaks are drilled via data lineage to source, fixed in mapping, and re-run. Then maker-checker sign-off, attestation, and submission as XBRL/XML through the regulator's channel.

Q2. "You find total assets on the return is 50 crore below the GL. What do you do?" *Answer:* Run the completeness check to locate the bucket, use lineage to drill from the failing cell to source, and I'd expect an unmapped or mis-mapped GL account. I add/correct the mapping, re-run, confirm the break is nil, and document the fix in the recon file — I never plug the difference.

Q3. "What's the difference between AxiomSL and OneSumX in practice?" *Answer:* Both are rules engines with lineage. AxiomSL (now Nasdaq/Adenza) is prized for deep data integration and transparent, user-configurable logic — you can see and change the calc. OneSumX leans on Wolters Kluwer's Regulatory Update Service, where WK's own regulatory team maintains the rule content, so it's more "managed". Regnology is strongest on EBA granular reporting like AnaCredit and is increasingly cloud/SaaS.

Learn/practise (free)

You cannot license these engines personally — they're bank-only. Build the identical skill for free:

- **Rebuild the pipeline in Excel/Power Query + Python.** Take a fake GL CSV, write a mapping table, use `merge / XLOOKUP` to classify, compute RWA and ratios, then code the validation rules as boolean asserts and a GL-recon check. This is the platform in miniature.
- **Read the actual templates.** EBA "reporting frameworks" (COREP/FINREP) and their **validation rules** lists are published free; download a COREP template and its rules and reproduce the arithmetic.
- **RBI:** read the ADF/RBS return formats and the CIMS documentation on the RBI website; map a sample trial balance to Form A / capital-adequacy return.
- **XBRL:** install the free **Arelle** open-source XBRL processor and validate a sample EBA instance to see taxonomy-based validation first-hand.
- **Vendor learning:** Wolters Kluwer, Nasdaq/Adenza and Regnology publish free webinars, product docs and demo videos — watch them to learn the exact menu/vocabulary ("ControllerView", "Data Integration Layer", "Rcloud").

Reg-Reporting Interview Drills + Calendar & Cheat-Sheet

What you'll be able to do

This chapter turns everything from the reg-reporting module into **exam-ready recall**. After it you'll be able to: compute CAR/CRAR, LCR and NSFR live on a whiteboard with the numbers tying out; explain any major return (COREP, FINREP, LCR, RBI Form A, DSB III) in two clean sentences; describe **data lineage** and why it matters; and rattle off the key ratios, thresholds, return names, filing frequencies and platform vendors without notes. It doubles as a one-page cheat-sheet you can revise the morning of the interview.

The essentials

Interviewers for GCC / Luxoft-type reg-reporting seats test three things: **(1) do the arithmetic** — can you actually compute the ratios; **(2) do you understand the return** — what it captures and why; **(3) do you get the control** — lineage, reconciliation, four-eyes, taxonomy. Below are the drills with model answers, then the cheat-sheet.

Hands-on — step by step (the drills)

Drill 1 — Compute CAR / CRAR

Given: CET1 = ₹1,150 cr, AT1 = ₹150 cr, Tier 2 = ₹200 cr; Credit RWA = 7,500, Market RWA = 900, Operational RWA = 1,600.

Work it: - Tier 1 = CET1 + AT1 = 1,150 + 150 = **1,300** - Total capital = Tier 1 + Tier 2 = 1,300 + 200 = **1,500**
- Total RWA = 7,500 + 900 + 1,600 = **10,000** - **CET1 ratio** = 1,150 / 10,000 = **11.50%** - **Tier 1 ratio** = 1,300 / 10,000 = **13.00%** - **CRAR (Total)** = 1,500 / 10,000 = **15.00%**

Say this: "CRAR is total regulatory capital over risk-weighted assets. RBI's minimum is 9%, plus a 2.5% capital-conservation buffer, so effectively **11.5%**; CET1 min is 5.5% + CCB. At 15% CRAR and 11.5% CET1 this bank is comfortably above requirement, with ~3.5% headroom on total capital."

Drill 2 — Compute LCR

Given: HQLA = ₹4,000 cr (all Level 1). Stressed outflows over 30 days: retail deposits 20,000 × 5% = 1,000; operational wholesale 8,000 × 25% = 2,000; non-operational wholesale 5,000 × 40% = 2,000. Stressed inflows: contractual loan inflows 3,000 × 50% = 1,500.

Work it: - Total outflows = 1,000 + 2,000 + 2,000 = **5,000** - Total inflows = **1,500**, capped at 75% of outflows = 3,750 → 1,500 stands - **Net cash outflows** = 5,000 - 1,500 = **3,500** - **LCR** = HQLA / net outflows = 4,000 / 3,500 = **114.3%**

Say this: "LCR ensures 30 days of survival in stress. Minimum is **100%**. At 114% we hold enough HQLA to cover a month of net stressed outflows. Note the **inflow cap at 75% of outflows** — a bank can't rely on more than 75% of outflows being met by inflows, so it must always hold some buffer."

Drill 3 — NSFR (quick)

Given: Available Stable Funding (ASF) = ₹9,000 cr, Required Stable Funding (RSF) = ₹8,200 cr. **NSFR** = $ASF/RSF = 9,000/8,200 = 109.8\%$, min 100%. Structural, one-year horizon vs LCR's 30-day. Both must be $\geq 100\%$.

Drill 4 — Explain a return

Prompt: "What is COREP?" — "COREP (Common Reporting) is the EBA's harmonised prudential return: own funds, capital ratios, credit/market/operational RWA, large exposures, leverage ratio and the LCR/NSFR liquidity templates. Its sister is **FINREP** (Financial Reporting) — IFRS balance-sheet, P&L and asset-quality data. COREP = capital & risk; FINREP = financial statements. Both filed as XBRL against the EBA taxonomy, usually quarterly."

Prompt: "RBI Form A?" — "Form A is the fortnightly return of a bank's liabilities and assets in India used to compute **CRR and SLR** compliance — demand and time liabilities (NDTL) against cash and SLR securities held."

Drill 5 — Explain data lineage

Say this: "Data lineage is the documented path from a reported cell back to the source transaction and system. If a regulator questions 'other assets = 340 cr', lineage lets me drill: reported cell → reg line-item mapping → GL account 1950 → sub-ledger entry → originating trade. It's essential for **reconciliation** (prove the return ties to the GL), **audit** (evidence every number), and **error resolution** (find where a break enters). No lineage = you can't defend a number."

The output

The finished artefact is the cheat-sheet — memorise it:

Key ratios & thresholds (Basel III / RBI 2026)

Ratio	Formula	Minimum
CET1	CET1 capital / RWA	4.5% (RBI 5.5%) + 2.5% CCB
Tier 1	Tier 1 / RWA	6% (RBI 7%)
CRAR / CAR	Total capital / RWA	8% (RBI 9%) + 2.5% CCB → 11.5%
Leverage ratio	Tier 1 / total exposure	3% (RBI 3.5–4%)
LCR	HQLA / 30-day net stressed outflows	$\geq 100\%$
NSFR	Available SF / Required SF	$\geq 100\%$
Large exposure	to single counterparty	$\leq 25\%$ of Tier 1

Key returns & who files what

Return	Regulator	Covers	Frequency
COREP	EBA / PRA	Own funds, RWA, LR, LCR, NSFR, large exposures	Quarterly
FINREP	EBA / PRA	IFRS B/S, P&L, asset quality	Quarterly
AnaCredit	ECB	Loan-level credit data	Monthly
FR Y-9C / FFIEC 031	US Fed / FFIEC	Bank holding co. financials / Call Report	Quarterly
Form A	RBI	NDTL for CRR/SLR	Fortnightly
RLC / LCR return	RBI	Liquidity coverage	Monthly
DSB III / RBS	RBI	Risk-based supervision data	Quarterly/Annual
CIMS returns	RBI	Centralised Information Mgmt System filings	Various

Filing calendar (typical)

Frequency	Examples	Timing after period-end
Fortnightly	RBI Form A	~7 days
Monthly	LCR, AnaCredit	~15–30 days
Quarterly	COREP, FINREP, Call Report	~30–45 days
Annual	Pillar 3, RBS	3–6 months

Platforms & vendors

Platform	Vendor (2026)	Note
ControllerView	AxiomSL → Adenza → Nasdaq	Deep data integration, configurable logic
OneSumX	Wolters Kluwer	Managed Regulatory Update Service
Rcloud / ABACUS	Regnology	EBA granular, AnaCredit, cloud/SaaS
Vermeg / AGILE	Vermeg	Also used in EU

The five-stage workflow (one line)

Source → Map → Validate → Reconcile to GL → Sign-off & submit (XBRL).

Checks, gotchas & red flags

- **LCR inflow cap** — always cap inflows at 75% of outflows before dividing.
- **Buffers on top of minimums** — quote 11.5% CRAR (9% + 2.5% CCB) for RBI, not the bare 9%; interviewers listen for the buffer.
- **CET1 ≤ Tier 1 ≤ Total capital** — if your numbers break this ordering you've made an error.
- **Return ties to GL** — if asked about a break, never "plug" it; drill lineage.

- **XBRL taxonomy version** — filing against the wrong DPM/taxonomy = rejection.
- **Don't confuse LCR (30-day, liquidity stress) with NSFR (1-year, structural)** or FINREP (financials) with COREP (capital).

Interview drill

Q1. "A bank's CRAR is 15% but CET1 is only 6%. Is that a problem?" *Answer:* "CET1 at 6% is above the 4.5% Basel minimum but, after the 2.5% CCB, the effective CET1 requirement is ~7% (RBI 8%). So despite a healthy 15% total CRAR, the bank may be **breaching its CET1 buffer** and could face distributable-profit restrictions. Total capital adequacy can mask weak core capital — always look at CET1 separately."

Q2. "Why do regulators want granular / loan-level data like AnaCredit instead of just totals?" *Answer:* "Granular data lets the regulator run its own analytics — concentration, sector risk, IFRS-9 staging — rather than trusting bank-computed aggregates, and it enables consistency checks across banks. It shifts the calculation burden and reduces the room for classification games. The trade-off is far heavier data-quality and lineage demands on the bank."

Q3. "How do you know a return is correct before you submit?" *Answer:* "Three gates: the engine runs the regulator's validation rules with zero blocking failures; the return reconciles exactly to the trial balance/audited financials with any timing differences documented; and four-eyes maker-checker sign-off with variance commentary explaining material QoQ movements. Only then is the XBRL instance generated and filed."

Learn/practise (free)

- **Drill the ratios cold** with random inputs until CAR, LCR and NSFR are reflexive — 10 minutes a day with flashcards.
- **BIS Basel III framework** (bis.org) — the definitive free source for capital and liquidity rules; read the LCR and NSFR standards.
- **EBA reporting frameworks** — download real COREP/FINREP templates and validation-rule lists; reproduce them in Excel.
- **RBI Master Directions** on capital adequacy, LCR and returns — the primary source for the India-specific numbers and forms.
- **Arele (free XBRL tool)** — validate a sample EBA instance to feel taxonomy-based validation.
- **Mock the interview:** record yourself computing a ratio out loud in under 90 seconds — fluency under time pressure is what actually gets tested.